on 12 September. There, I was categorically told: 'Your daughter is the only one who is coming in the way of normalcy in the state. Withdraw your daughter or bear the consequences …'. No, I don't want to go into full details of this meeting because I think it does not behoove my position, but they tried their best to do a little more than intimidate me. Thereafter, in my wisdom, I thought it best to leave the scene. I thought it might help the law and order situation. People say that I ran away – well, actually, I sped away and that too in the dead of the night. Circumstances had got beyond control and I realised that if I informed anybody my departure would be made impossible. I had earlier asked for leave, but this was not accepted. So, I left without asking. I left a letter saying that I was leaving under compelling situations and that I would be away for as long as the situation warrants, so that I may please be granted leave. I regret leaving a place like this. My term was over four months ago, and I had wanted to leave, leaving goodwill behind. It is very unfortunate that all my slogging, struggling and hard work there had to get lost in one Mizo emotion.

I had no option but to resort to this. During my police training we often sang the '*Hum honge kaamyaab*' [we will be successful] song. I stand by this. I will not surrender to injustice. They say that they will take stronger action. Well, I am ready. The ball is in their court. My daughter shall continue attending classes and I shall not meet people here or lobby for my case. I am claiming something on merit which, I believe, speaks for itself. If it ultimately does not, I shall do whatever I can, to protect my daughter's career. I have seen her slogging to make it. How can I, as a mother, take away what is the rightful fruit of her labour? It's the question of her career, her life. There's something called natural justice in law – this is on my daughter's side. What these people will be doing if they try to have my daughter thrown out is to go against the law – break it. I don't think they will dare do that. I am sure that justice will prevail. It must prevail. I am here to ensure that it prevails.

(*The Sunday Observer*, 27 September–6 October 1992)

Once the students of Mizoram realized that she had actually left, they called off their agitation immediately. The state promptly issued orders for the cancellation of the allotment of a seat to Sukriti (Saina) Bedi. The authorities of the Lady Hardinge Medical College, Delhi, however refused to take cognizance of such orders on the ground that they had no lawful reason to decline a student registered on the college's rolls.

The state of Mizoram tried to file a petition in the higher courts. But the Supreme Court was not even willing to consider it. The matter rested at the contention that 'seats allocated by the Government of India are not for Mizos but Mizoram, which is a state of India'.

Since then, non-Mizos, who were/are similarly placed, continue to get the benefit of joining professional courses and the Government of India order still remains valid.

But for Kiran this was yet another fight for justice in a long series. If she won in one way, she paid the price in another. She remained without work for more than nine months after returning to Delhi, till such a state of affairs was questioned by the accountant general of India. But who knew what destiny had in store for her? After months of endless waiting, without any posting and without any work, she was 'dumped' at Tihar Jail, New Delhi.

The rest is history. Read on …